



Disney settles with Black Widow
Disney settles Scarlett Johansson lawsuit over 'Black Widow' streaming strategy.
<https://digit.in/oct21-81>



LoL TV Series on Netflix
Netflix's League of Legends TV series debuts November 6th on Netflix.
<https://digit.in/oct21-82>



Predicting Technology

The future is not what it used to be

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It is 2021, and the 19th century futurists apparently got it all wrong. The cities do not have climate controlled enclosures, personal helicopters are not the primary mode of transport, emergency responders do not have flapping wing backpacks, there is no tourism and recreation industry on the seafloors, and our apples are not as big as our watermelons. We do have domestic house cleaning robots, but not the promised dusting robots, and floors can hardly count as the entire house. There are many ideas that could be real but aren't, such as space saving pneumatic furniture or attaching balloons to cars, pets and people to make everything lighter. The magazines in the 20th century such as Popular Mechanics and Wireless World had concepts much closer to reality, with prize winning physicists authoring articles. In the atomic age though, a small number of futurists and thinkers got some predictions right with chilling accuracy.

RICHARD FEYNMAN

Feynman gave an infamous lecture in 1959, known as "there's plenty of room at the bottom", that foresaw the advent of miniaturisation and nanotechnology. He predicted that information storage devices would get increasingly smaller, providing engineers with the comparison of information stored in cells. At that time computers occupied entire rooms, but Feynman said that it was possible to build these machines up at atomic and molecular scales, and shrink down most existing devices. He also predicted tiny robotic probes loaded with medical payloads, enclosed within pills. Researchers are developing medications just like that, only made of molecular machines instead of mechanical ones. Feynman saw a miniaturisation of not just electronics, but also mechanical devices, which is a field waiting for its revolution.

ARTHUR C CLARKE

Clarke, based on calculations by the original space architect, Tsiolkovsky, conceptualised the geosynchronous

satellite, and modestly considered it to be his only original idea. Most of the telecommunications satellites in use today are deployed in the "Clarke" orbit. Clarke also anticipated the advent of remote robotic surgery, even identifying the lag as a critical hurdle that had to be overcome. In his public talks and vast bibliography, Clarke has also predicted the internet with a search engine to look up information, but also complete with all its trappings including data mining, targeted ads and spam. His vision of the ebook reader for accessing newspapers was also prescient, down to a GUI with a thumbnail expanding to fill the whole screen. Oh, and he also foresaw Skype or Zoom.

RAY KURZWEIL

Ray Kurzweil foresaw the internet revolution and the explosion of online users, as well as correctly predicted that artificial intelligence would be able to defeat human chess players. He also correctly predicted that computers would get increasingly sleeker, would get small enough